07 · Transition and Closure Plan: writing guide

Owner suggestion: Member 3. **Length:** about 2 pages. **Time:** 25 to 30 minutes.

Purpose

Show how the system and knowledge **pass to whoever runs it next** (transition) and how the project is **formally finished** (closure). The brief lists "Transition & Closure Plan" as a final deliverable.

Key ideas explained simply

- **Transition (handover):** moving from "the project team builds it" to "someone else runs and supports it". Covers handover items, training, support and go-live.
- **Closure:** the formal end: confirm everything was delivered, get acceptance, release resources, archive, record lessons.
- **Acceptance criteria:** what the client must see to agree the project is complete.
- **Post-implementation review:** looking back to check benefits and lessons.

Sections to write

1. Purpose and scope (2 to 3 sentences)

Who is receiving the system (for a student project: the lecturer and, in a real roll-out, CPUT or the student community) and what is being handed over.

2. Deliverables handed over (table)

Deliverable	Where it is	Who receives it	Status
Working application (web app and API)	Project folder / zip	Lecturer	
Source code and history	Git repository	Lecturer / next team	
Database scripts and demo data	`backend/db/`, `demo/demo-data-backup.sql`		
Setup guide	`README.md`		
Deployment guide	`DEPLOYMENT.md`		
Demo video (MP4)	Submission	Lecturer	
Portfolio documents	Submission	Lecturer	
Demo accounts and credentials	In the handover note (never real passwords)		
Photo credits	`backend/uploads/products/CREDITS.txt`		

3. Transition approach

Describe how someone could take over and run it. Facts you can use:

1. **Set up:** install Java 21, Node, MySQL; create the database; start the backend and frontend (README steps 0 to 5).
2. **Production readiness checklist** (from DEPLOYMENT.md): set a real `JWT_SECRET`, database password and push (VAPID) keys; run with `SPRING_PROFILES_ACTIVE=prod` (the app refuses to start with development secrets); configure the allowed web address (CORS); serve over HTTPS; create the first admin account; point the frontend to the real API address.
3. **Hosting:** the app is not yet hosted; choose a host for the API, a managed database and a static host for the front end; move photo storage to cloud storage before using several servers.
4. **Data:** demo data can be loaded for training; real data starts empty.
5. **Go-live approach:** pilot on one campus first (for example Bellville), gather feedback, then widen.

4. Training and support

- **Admins:** how to approve vendors, review reports, remove listings, suspend and reinstate accounts, handle appeals.
- **Users:** short guide or video on listing, chatting, confirming receipt and rating, reporting.
- **Support:** who answers questions, how problems are reported, response expectations. For a student project, say who maintains it after submission, or state that there is no ongoing support.
- **Maintenance:** backups of the database and photos; updating dependencies; reviewing reports; monitoring.

5. Known limitations and recommended next steps (table)

Item	Why it matters	Recommended next step
No email verification	Anyone could use another student's address	Send a verification link
No payments / escrow	Trade is in person	Integrate a gateway with hosted checkout
No two-factor login	Needed once money moves	Add 2FA for high-value purchases
Photos on local disk	Lost on some hosts	Cloud object storage
Rate limiter is single-server	Needs shared store when scaled	Shared store or proxy rule
Database schema made by Hibernate	Changes not reviewable	Move to Flyway migrations
No account deletion or privacy policy	Data protection (POPIA)	Policy, retention rule, deletion
No independent penetration test	Unknown weaknesses	Test before public launch

6. Closure activities (checklist table)

Closure activity	Done?	Owner	Date
All deliverables submitted and checked against the brief			
Acceptance / sign-off obtained (lecturer)			
Final demo and video completed			
Open defects and risks documented with next steps			
Code and documents archived (repository tagged or backed up)			
Team members released and workload ended			
Third-party material acknowledged (photo credits, libraries)			
Lessons-learned session held			
Final communication to stakeholders sent			

7. Closure criteria and sign-off

State the conditions for "project complete" (deliverables submitted; "Must" requirements delivered or limitations documented; demo accepted). Add a small sign-off block:

Name	Role	Signature	Date
	Project manager		
	Lecturer / assessor		

8. Post-project review (3 to 5 sentences, your words)

Did the project meet its objectives? Which benefits could be measured later (number of users, successful sales, reports resolved)? Link to the Reflection document.

Common mistakes

- Only technical instructions with nothing on training, support or closure.
- No limitations or next steps.
- Putting real passwords or secrets into the document.
- Skipping the sign-off and lessons-learned parts.

Checklist

- [ ] Handover deliverables table
- [ ] Setup and production checklist
- [ ] Training, support and maintenance
- [ ] Limitations and next steps
- [ ] Closure checklist, criteria and sign-off